



Crows pickup trash

Crows are being trained to pickup trash at French park by rewarding them with food. <https://digit.in/nov-18-37-1>



Tor-only SIM

A UK mobile carrier now offers a data-only SIM that ensuring that only encrypted data makes it to the internet. <https://digit.in/nov-18-37-2>

Apple iPhone XS Max 512 GB

The most powerful iPhone. Ever.



By the time the iPhone launch event rolled around, we knew what the phone would look like and what kind of hardware it would have. The phone's price tag is high enough to cause most sane people to stop and think about what they're about to do, so if you need convincing one way or the other, do read on.

A bigger, but familiar design

The iPhone XS Max uses the familiar glass-sandwich design. The stainless-steel frame feels incredibly posh and sometimes gives off the impression that this is the source of the added heft. The glass panels blend beautifully into the metal frame, giving the phone a seamless feel.

The iPhone XS Max is now IP68 rated, so we dunked our lakh and a half rupee review unit into some water and carbonated drinks, and the phone continued to function perfectly fine.

Display-par-none?

The display now also has a 120 Hz detection rate, meaning it registers even the minutest of finger touches. The panel also delivers an exceptionally smooth visual experience that is stutter free. This is honestly a display you wouldn't want to put a screen protector on.

Any content that has to take up the whole screen ends up getting limited to the bottom edge of the notch. Because of the notch, users are able to take advantage of two features; FaceID and portrait mode in selfies. FaceID works in poor lighting conditions and at awkward angles.

Performance to the Max

The iPhone XS Max is powered by Apple's new A12-Bionic chipset and we see the chip outpace every Android



It is also a little surprising that even though Apple has had a year to work on their Portrait Mode algorithm since the Pixel 2 XL came out, their results are still not a match for the Pixel.

Selfie camera on steroids

Apple continues to use a modest 7-megapixel sensor along with a f/2.2 aperture lens for the front-facing camera, but this time, we also get optical image stabilisation. Portrait mode is aided by the depth sensor that Apple uses for FaceID. The iPhone's selfies are impressive and you wouldn't be disappointed.

Battery life

The 3,174 mAh capacity is definitely at the lower end of the spectrum for flagship smartphones, coming in second only to the LG G7+ with its 3,000 mAh battery. Geekbench 4's battery test returned a rather short 5 hours and 52 minutes. In real-life usage as a primary device, the iPhone XS Max would easily last until the next day.

Verdict

The iPhone XS Max scores a very low value for money score based on all the features and performance it offers. Keeping this in mind, the iPhone XS Max, with its rather ambitious starting price of ₹1,09,990 for the 64GB variant and ₹1,44,990 for the 512GB variant is only meant for a very select audience. As good and flawless as the iPhone XS Max may be, at this point, you are paying more for the premium than you are for the features and performance.

—Swapnil Mathur

SPECIFICATIONS

DIMENSIONS (MM): 157.50 x 77.40 x 7.70 | WEIGHT (G): 208.00 | IP RATING: IP68 | SCREEN SIZE (INCHES): 6.50 | RESOLUTION: 1242x2688 pixels | PROCESSOR: Apple A12 Bionic | REAR CAMERA: 12 MP (f/1.8, 14-micron) + 12 MP (f/2.4) | FRONT CAMERA: 7 MP (f/2.2) | BAROMETER: Yes

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phone in the market as of now. Whether it's editing RAW files in Adobe Lightroom or playing Asphalt 9, PUBG or Fortnite, everything just works without a glitch. During heavy use, you can feel the phone heat up a little, but it isn't anything out of the ordinary. Qualcomm

now has a benchmark in performance it must meet for the next flagship SoC they launch.

Dual-camera, Portrait Mode and SmartHDR

Under the surface is where Apple has made a ton of improvements. The iPhone XS Max managed to lock focus on 9 out of 10 situations, even those that were in the near-pitch dark.

When it comes to quality of images, the iPhone XS Max takes its HDR algorithms to the next level with smart HDR. The iPhone's have a tendency to favour a cooler white balance, especially in mixed lighting conditions.